topic for future research with a wider scope than the present study.

3 In this chapter I refer to narratives related to "democracy" and "democratization". I recognize that these words are often connected to contrasting concepts — one about a vision of political life and the other about a process of change away from an alternate form of political life, and toward "democracy". These two concepts have their own subfields of scholarly investigation. However, I argue that these concepts are also closely connected. Meanings of "democracy" are built around reactions to particular problems that "democracy" is intended to solve. In other words, the vision of "democracy" depends on an understanding of the process of "democratization". Meanwhile, the meaning of "democratization" is contingent on varying constructions of the vision of "democracy". In this sense, both "democracy" and "democratization" are "essentially contested concepts" and the meaning of one is, in certain respects, contingent on the meaning of the other.

4 I use the word "decentred" here to refer to the understanding that narratives do not have a *core* definition. Bevir and Rhodes (2003, p. 2) suggest that one of the dangers of working at the aggregate level is that "we can neglect the beliefs of the individuals lumped together in a tradition". Decentring an aggregate concept like "narrative" serves to show how within a particular coalition of actors there may be more nuanced strands of narrative.

5 Pseudonyms are used to refer to participants in this study.

6 I use the Myanmar word "Bamar" here to refer to the majority Burman ethnic group.

7 Walton (2015) convincingly traces the theme of unity in Myanmar politics further into the colonial and pre-colonial period.

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